

MIKE E UNDERWOOD

Principal / Staff Solutions Architect

Leesburg, Georgia (Remote-First; Relocation Considered for the Right Role)

+1-770-826-7367 | mikee.underwood@gmail.com

[LinkedIn Profile](#) | [GitHub](#) | mikeeunderwood.dev

Summary

Principal/Staff Solutions Architect with deep experience across systems architecture, enterprise architecture, and digital operations architecture, spanning high-volume payment platforms, CMS modernization, cloud-native engineering, and large-scale integration ecosystems. Combines hands-on engineering depth with architectural leadership to shape roadmaps, define service boundaries, modernize legacy systems, and guide cross-functional teams across .NET, Java, Azure, and distributed environments. Recognized for improving reliability, reducing delivery timelines, and aligning technical direction with business strategy across financial services, insurance, and digital consulting organizations.

Core Skills & Technical Expertise

Architecture & System Design

- Systems Architecture, Enterprise Architecture, Digital Operations Architecture
- Domain-Driven Design, SOA, event-driven systems, modular monolith → microservices
- API-first design, schema governance, integration patterns, orchestration workflows
- Cloud-native modernization (Azure-first; AWS serverless exposure), hybrid architectures, platform evolution
- Multi-tenant platform design and PCI/HIPAA-aligned architecture

Engineering & Development

- C#, .NET / ASP.NET Core, Java, C++, JavaScript/TypeScript
- SQL Server, Azure SQL, MySQL/MariaDB, Informix, Oracle
- REST/JSON APIs, middleware, service composition, serverless (AWS Lambda)
- React, Vue.js, Node.js, MVC, headless CMS patterns

Cloud, Infrastructure & Operations

- Azure, AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, IIS, Red Hat Linux
- CI/CD governance (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions), automation, IaC patterns
- Observability architecture: Application Insights, distributed tracing, telemetry pipelines
- SRE-aligned reliability engineering, performance optimization, incident response

Leadership & Delivery

- Architecture governance, roadmap development, TRB/ARB participation
- Cross-functional leadership across engineering, product, security, and infrastructure
- Agile/SDLC governance, DevOps enablement, stakeholder alignment
- Technical communication, mentoring, distributed team collaboration

Experience

Rightpoint Consulting — Remote

Solutions Architect, Digital Operations Architecture (Jan 2020 – Nov 2025)

Designed and delivered enterprise CMS, retail, and e-commerce architectures across Sitecore, Optimizely, and ASP.NET Core, blending hands-on engineering with architectural leadership.

- Architected CMS and digital experience platforms using ASP.NET MVC, React/TypeScript, and headless integration patterns.
- Designed backend payment workflows using .NET Web APIs, AWS Lambda, and Azure Service Bus for reliable, event-driven processing.
- Built cloud deployment architectures across AKS, Azure VMs, and serverless components; implemented CI/CD pipelines and observability instrumentation.
- Diagnosed systemic issues using logs, metrics, and distributed tracing; delivered fixes across APIs, data access, and cloud infrastructure.
- Mentored DEV/QA teams on implementation patterns, debugging, and code quality to preserve architectural intent.
- Authored API specifications, integration contracts, and architectural documentation; collaborated with security teams on HIPAA-aligned integrations.
- Partnered with stakeholders to shape technical roadmaps, evaluate solution tradeoffs, and align delivery with long-term architectural strategy.

AXIS Capital — Alpharetta, GA

Application Delivery Lead, Enterprise Architecture (Mar 2018 – Dec 2019)

Led delivery of enterprise software solutions aligned to business and CIO goals, ensuring architectural consistency and adherence to enterprise standards.

- Defined requirements and translated them into application and integration architectures aligned with EA principles and security guidelines.
- Served as Scrum Master and team lead, coordinating development activities and ensuring predictable delivery across distributed teams.

- Led offshore DEV/QA teams, providing technical guidance and reviewing implementation approaches.
- Managed delivery budgets, resource planning, and cross-team coordination.
- Collaborated with support teams to troubleshoot production issues and improve system reliability.

Fiserv — Alpharetta, GA

18-year progression across five architecture and engineering roles supporting high-volume payment, billing, and e-bill platforms used by thousands of financial institutions.

Principal Solutions Architect → Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect → Senior Software Architect → Software Architect → Senior Software Engineer

(Systems Architecture, Platform Modernization, Payments & eBill Solutions)

Principal Solutions Architect (Aug 2014 – Feb 2018)

- Partnered with senior leadership to define and maintain a three-year business and technology roadmap for the CheckFreePay division.
- Translated business strategy into system architecture requirements, guiding platform evolution and modernization.
- Chaired the Technical Review Board governing production readiness and architectural compliance.
- Led migration of all Walk-In Payments platform from legacy environments to the go-forward Fiserv data center, including hands-on development (Informix 4GL/C → C#), scripting modernization (Unix → PowerShell), and database migration (Informix → SQL Server).
- Designed barcode-based Walk-In Payments workflows and the supporting .NET Web Service APIs that enabled retail point-of-sale payment capture and error-free transaction processing.
- Ensured architectural compliance across PCI-regulated payment workflows and audit-driven operational controls, partnering with security and operations teams to maintain certification readiness.
- Redesigned compliance reporting and monitoring, achieving 100% reporting accuracy.

Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect (Mar 2012 – Jul 2014)

- Managed the Biller Solutions architecture team, including hiring, coaching, and performance evaluation.
- Defined and maintained a three-year business roadmap and supporting architecture roadmap.
- Led modernization initiatives and delivery of a .NET Web Service API layer across .NET and Java products.
- Partnered with senior leadership to align architectural direction with business strategy and operational goals.

Senior Software Architect (Sep 2008 – Feb 2012)

- Served on the Architecture Review Board, shaping new Biller Solutions initiatives and integration patterns.
- Designed and delivered the **eBill Easy Activation** platform (230% adoption increase).
- Built a cross-platform authentication mechanism reducing digital certificates from hundreds to one.
- Designed the .NET SaaS Web Service API that became the foundation for eBill capabilities used by 4,000+ financial sponsors, Bank of America, and MyCheckFree.com.
- Led architecture and delivery of the responsive MyCheckFree.com mobile experience and supporting Java REST APIs.
- Built the .NET eBill platform that reduced implementation timelines from nine months to two.

Software Architect (Jul 2001 – Aug 2008)

- Founding member of an Agile innovation group focused on rapid prototyping of new payment and billing concepts.
- Designed and delivered multiple Java and ASP.NET payment solutions, several commercialized or sold to third parties.
- Led ASP.NET initiatives including ACH orchestration, correspondence systems, and consumer payment flows.
- Designed a Java biller-direct payment and presentment platform integrating iSeries and mainframe systems.
- Co-designed a .NET-based SOA exposing mainframe capabilities; served as lead architect for eBill services.

Senior Software Engineer (Dec 1999 – Jun 2001)

- Delivered client integration solutions for CheckFree's eBill and payment systems, ranging from SSO to full hosted implementations.
- Developed project plans, estimates, and integration approaches in collaboration with sales and project management teams.

Earlier Career

RIB Software (BSD) – Senior Software Engineer

Sales Technologies – Software Engineer

Universal Microsystems – Software Engineer

Education

Master of Science, Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University, J. Mack Robinson College of Business

BBA, Computer Information Systems

Georgia State University, J. Mack Robinson College of Business

Certifications

Sitecore Experience Solution 9 Developer